Documentation — Sweetheat Kök by Bushra

1. Design Journey

My Idea:

My website is called **Sweetheat Kök by Bushra**. It is a personal cooking portfolio inspired by my Bangladeshi and Asian background and my interest in European food and presentation.
I wanted the website to feel personal rather than looking like a normal recipe website. Instead of focusing only on recipes, I wanted to show my cooking journey, the skills I have developed and some of the food I have created.
The website has four connected pages: **Home, My Cooking Journey, Recipes & Skills, and Gallery**.

Home Page:

I started by creating a simple home page that introduces the idea of Euro-Asian fusion. The page explains how Asian heritage and European inspiration influence my cooking.
I used a large introduction area followed by three content areas: Asian Heritage, European Inspiration and Fusion Creations. This helped me communicate the main idea of the website quickly.

My Cooking Journey:

The second page tells my personal cooking story. I organised the content chronologically, starting from my childhood, then moving to 2013 when I started taking cooking more seriously, my family experiences, moving to Sweden and finally developing cooking into a passion.

I used separate content sections with consistent spacing so that the long story would remain easy to read.

Recipes & Skills:

I decided not to make this page another recipe list. Instead, I focused on the practical skills behind my cooking.
The page explains how I learned cooking from my mother, recipe books and practice. It then presents skills such as preparation, marinating, spice layering, heat control, texture control and timing.
I also added a cooking process section to show how I normally approach cooking.

Gallery:

The final page contains a 3×3 gallery of nine original food photos. Each image has meaningful alternative text and a caption explaining the dish.
I also included a contact form with fields for name, email, subject and message

2. Design System:

I wanted all four pages to feel like one website rather than separate projects.
I used CSS custom properties for the main colours, spacing and typography.

My main colours are:

- **Main colour:** #8b3a3a
- **Accent colour:** #e8a87c
- **Light background:** #fff8f2
- **Dark text/footer:** #2f2522
- **White:** #ffffff

The dark red colour connects with the warmth of cooking and spices, while the light cream background gives the pages a softer appearance.

I also created reusable spacing variables such as small, medium and large spacing. This helped me keep similar distances between sections and content.

The same navigation style, footer style, typography and colour system are used throughout the website.

3. Technical Implementation:

I used **HTML and plain CSS** to build the website.

I used semantic HTML elements such as:

- <header> for the website header and navigation area.
- <main> for the main content of each page.
- <section> for separate content areas.
- <article> for individual skills and content cards.
- <footer> for the footer information.

Using these elements makes the structure clearer and helps accessibility.

CSS Custom Properties:

I used CSS custom properties in :root so that the main design values can be reused throughout the website.

For example:

```
:root {
    --main-color: #8b3a3a;
    --accent-color: #e8a87c;
    --light-color: #fff8f2;
    --dark-color: #2f2522;
}
```

This means I can change a main colour in one place instead of changing it throughout every selector.

Responsive Layout:

I used CSS Grid, Flexbox and media queries.

For example, the skills cards use a grid layout on larger screens and change to fewer columns on smaller screens.

I also changed the navigation to a vertical layout on smaller screens.

This allows the website to work on desktop and mobile screen sizes.

Interactions:

I added small hover effects to navigation links and content cards.

The transitions use a short duration such as:

transition: transform 0.3s ease;

This makes the interaction noticeable without making it distracting.

4. Accessibility and Responsiveness:

I tried to make the website simple and readable.

The navigation is available on every page and the current page is visually indicated using the active navigation style.

Images in the Gallery have meaningful alt text describing the food.

I also added visible focus styles for interactive elements such as links, buttons and form fields.

I tested the layout at different screen sizes using browser developer tools. In particular, I checked a mobile-width layout around 400px.

One issue I noticed was that the content could become too wide and difficult to read on smaller screens. I addressed this using responsive layouts, smaller padding and single-column layouts where necessary.

5. Seed Constraint — Balanced Form:

The assigned seed constraint, **Balanced Form**, influenced the structure of my website.

I used balanced spacing, consistent proportions and repeated card layouts throughout the pages.

For example, the Journey page uses equally spaced content sections, while the Recipes & Skills page uses balanced grids for the cooking skills.

The seed is therefore part of the visual structure rather than being hidden in the code.

6. Problem-Solving Record:

Problem 1 — Making the website responsive

Problem:
Some layouts looked good on a desktop screen but became crowded on a smaller screen.

Tried solution:
I first used the same desktop layout on smaller screens.

Final solution:
I added media queries that change grids into fewer columns and make the navigation vertical.

Why it worked:
The content gets more available space on narrow screens and becomes easier to read.

Problem 2 — Keeping all pages visually consistent

Problem:
Different pages could easily start looking like separate websites.

Tried solution:
I initially styled individual sections separately.

Final solution:
I created shared CSS variables for colours, spacing and typography and reused common navigation and footer styles.

Why it worked:
The same design values are used throughout the website, creating a consistent visual identity.

Problem 3 — Organising the Recipes & Skills page

Problem:
I did not want the page to simply become a list of recipes because the assignment focuses on cooking skills and how they were acquired.

Final solution:
I organised the page around learning methods, practical skills, cooking process, skills in practice and problem solving.

Why it worked:
The page demonstrates the development and use of my skills instead of only listing food.

7. Personal Reflection

Creating Sweetheat Kök has been different from simply making a normal website because the content is connected to my own experience. At the beginning, I mainly thought about how to present my cooking story and the food I have made. As I developed the

website, I realised that the design also needed to communicate something about me.

One of the most important decisions was to make the website about my cooking journey rather than only recipes. Cooking has been part of my life for many years, starting from watching my mother in the kitchen. Later, I learned through recipes and repeated practice. I wanted the website to show this development.

Technically, I learned more about organising a multi-page website and keeping a consistent design across different pages. Using CSS custom properties helped me understand why a design system is useful. Instead of choosing colours and spacing separately for every section, I could create common values and reuse them.

Responsive design was another important part of the project. A layout that looks good on a large monitor does not automatically work on a mobile screen. Testing smaller screen sizes helped me notice where navigation and content needed to change.

I also learned that building a polished website takes more than writing HTML. Small details such as spacing, hover effects, readable text, image descriptions and consistent navigation make a noticeable difference.

Overall, this project helped me combine something personal that I enjoy with the technical skills I have been learning. I am happy that the final website represents both my cooking journey and my development as a beginner web developer.